

**FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND LAW
OF BUSINESS**

MARK213 GROUP Project Report Coversheet

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Subject Code & Name: MARK213 Marketing Principles

Project Title: Old Chang Kee

Tutor's Name: Ms Cher Lim

Assignment Due Date:

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Introduction

Old Chang Kee is a well-known Singaporean food and beverage brand established in 1956, best recognised for its curry puffs and savoury snacks. Its product range includes curry puffs with various fillings, spring rolls, sotong balls, and fried chicken wings, positioned as convenient grab-and-go food items. It is known with numerous physical locations across shopping malls, MRT stations, business districts, neighbourhood centres of Singapore. It boasts a strong presence on both food delivery platforms Grab Food and Foodpanda, making it particularly accessible for the convenient consumer. Old Chang Kee's preferred targets are students, employed adults and travelling commuters looking for cheap and familiar local snacks. Often promoted on heated glass shelves ahead of the front stores and usually packaged in plain branded takeaway packaging, the brand's major players are Tip Top Curry puff, Curry Times, MrBean, along with other local snack kiosks. Old Chang Kee's core brand elements include its iconic red-and-yellow logo and a friendly, approachable brand tone reflecting local food heritage.



Key Marketing Concepts and Principles

Old Chang Kee, a Singaporean traditional food which is Halal Certified, is famous for its traditional curry puffs and hot fried finger foods. Looking at its current marketing strategy through the 4Ps and environmental lens shows both high and low, even with the nostalgic appeal being strong.

4Ps:

Product

Traditional products like curry puffs, fish balls, fish fillets and cheesy chicken balls are part of Old Chang Kee's product range. But in the process of changing consumer tastes, the brand has been slow to create. Although most of the menu is deep fried, health-conscious people are looking forward to wanting baked or plant-based options. This indicates a missed opportunity to broaden without upsetting the regular customers.

Price

The majority of Old Chang Kee's products are priced between \$1.60 and \$2.50 as a part of a value-for-money pricing plan. A set of meals or bundle discounts is very convenient for customers on a tight budget, like students and office workers. But also, this positioning can be hard, as there is a rise in ingredient and labour costs.



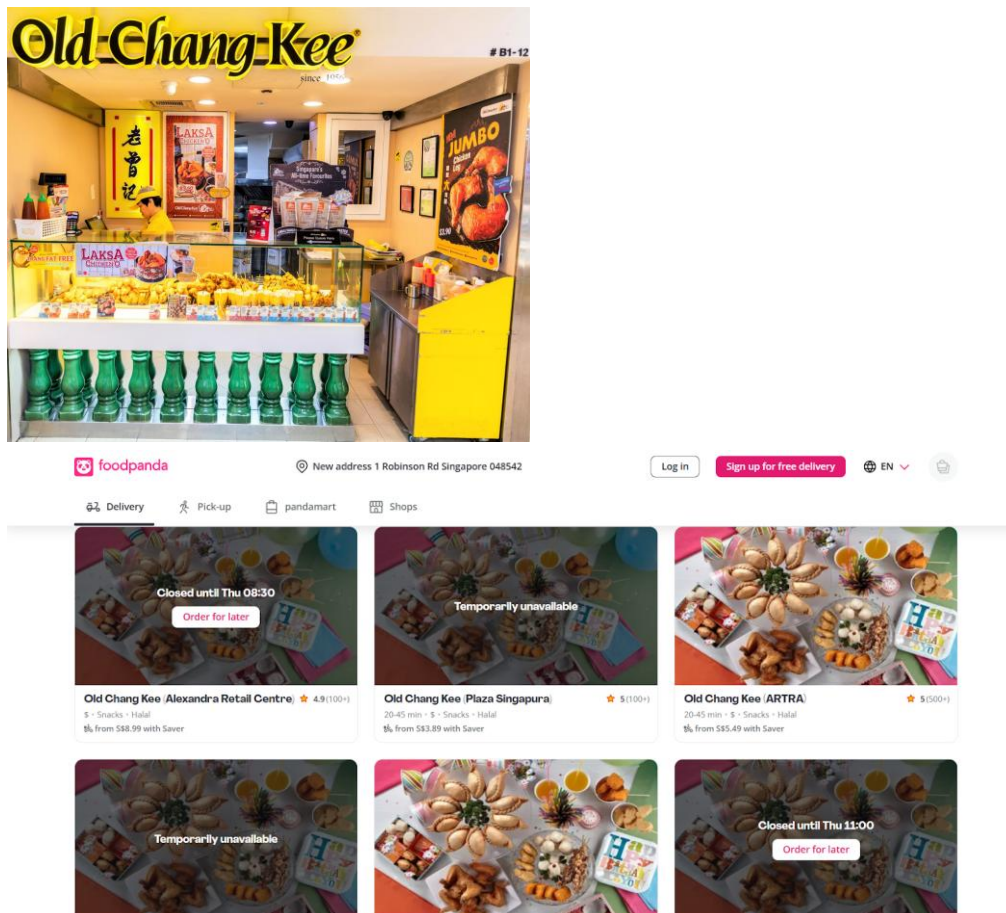
The image shows the Old Chang Kee logo at the top left, featuring the brand name in English and Chinese characters, with 'since 1956' below it. To the right of the logo is a circular emblem with Chinese characters. Below the logo is a table titled 'Frozen Snack Items Frying Time'. The table has three columns: 'Type of Food', 'Temperature (°C / °F)', and 'Time (Mins)'. It lists 18 items with their respective frying temperatures and times. At the bottom of the table, there is a red text note: 'Do take note that for *Chicken Wing, it comes with a packet of flour. Mix 300gm of water with the flour batter. Then cover the chicken wings with the mixed batter before deep frying it.'

Type of Food	Temperature (°C / °F)	Time (Mins)
Mini Curry Puff	150°C / 300 °F	10 - 13
Spring Roll	160°C / 325 °F	10
Sotong Ball	160°C / 325 °F	5 - 8
Chicken Nugget	160°C / 325 °F	5
Mini Sesame Ball	140°C / 275 °F	8 - 10
*Chicken Wing	160°C / 325 °F	10 - 12
Crab / Prawn Nugget	160°C / 325 °F	6 - 8
Fish Fillet	160°C / 325 °F	6 - 8
Chicken Wrap	140°C / 275 °F	7 - 10
Cheezy Chicken Sausage	140°C / 275 °F	3 - 4
Cheezy Chicken Ball	140°C / 275 °F	7 - 10
Seafood Vegetable Gyoza	160°C / 325 °F	5 - 8
Baby Squid	190°C / 375 °F	3
Chicken Bites	160°C / 325 °F	6

Do take note that for *Chicken Wing, it comes with a packet of flour.
Mix 300gm of water with the flour batter. Then cover the chicken wings with the mixed batter before deep frying it.

Place

Old Chang Kee is easily accessible with more than 90 locations, including in shopping centres and MRT stations. Takeout is ideal for Singapore's hectic way of life. However, a lot of stores lack seating, which prevents people from sitting and spending their time there. Although there are delivery apps posting Old Chang Kee, they are not very well known than the recent popular brands. This reduces the interest to consumers who order them digitally.



Promotion

In-store visibility and seasonal campaigns are key components of Old Chang Kee's marketing strategy. Instagram feature festive launches, but its TikTok presence is small, and the engagement is low. Old Chang Kee has not yet acquired the interactive, snackable content that younger consumers expect. Even though there are good reviews on Google and food blogs, it lacks enthusiasm for new products.



Environmental Factors

Micro factors show strong competition among Polar Puffs, BreadTalk, and 7-Eleven. These competitors provide healthier or more varied options, and they tend to advertise their new products more. Macro factors show a move towards digital convenience and wellness, particularly on social and technological ones. The slow adoption of technology and the lack of healthy products may be an obstruction to the future growth of Old Chang Kee.

Strategic Insight

Old Chang Kee's strength lies in traditional resonance and pervasiveness. However, to increase in growth, it must evolve, especially in digital engagement and product creation. The brand's current strategy is solid but has a risk of not growing unless it engages with the consumers.

Consumer insights :

Summary of customer interviews

1. Alex (A student at SIM in Singapore.)

He says: "If I saw the Old Chang Kee, I would probably buy it, but I wouldn't specifically plan to buy it."

Need: Instant hunger solution during transit

Motivation: Convenience over craving

Behavior: 80+ monthly MRT or Bus commutes

2. Ricky (A student at SIM in Singapore Alex's friend)

He says: "I love their curry puffs, and I usually buy a serving of Old Chang Kee curry puffs to bring to group meetings to share with my group members."

Need: Affordable group snacking for study sessions

Motivation: Cultural familiarity

Behavior: Prefers Old Chang Kee over pricier cafes when self-funding student group snacks

3. Shirley (Shopping mall staff)

She says: "I really love this snack. But I've noticed that Lao Xiang Ji hasn't launched any new products in a long time, and I haven't seen any related news on Instagram. Now I prefer to buy food from BreadTalk."

Need: Novelty in menu/seasonal offerings

Motivation: Seeking snack discovery via social media

Behavior: Browsing food social media 3 times a week; prefers limited edition or seasonal snacks.

Simple consumer journey

<i>Stage</i>	<i>Pain Points</i>	<i>Old Chang Kee Gaps</i>
<i>Awareness</i>	<i>Relies on physical sighting</i>	<i>Zero digital discovery</i>
<i>Consideration</i>	<i>No novelty appeal</i>	<i>Static menu, no seasonal hype</i>

<i>Purchase</i>	<i>Group orders lack combos</i>	<i>No meal deals for sharing</i>
<i>Usage</i>	<i>transit fuel(Alex)</i> <i>study fuel(Ricky)</i>	<i>Packaging not share-friendly</i>
<i>Repeat</i>	<i>Defection if new options exist (Shirley)</i>	<i>Habitual loyalty missing</i>

Behaviour-based persona(s)

Persona 1: Impulse Buyer Alex

"It's there → I buy it"

Triggers: Gap in commute, no breakfast

Pain points: Packaging messy for walking

Decision drivers: ≤90 sec queue, visible kiosk or numerous stores

Persona 2: Group Provider Ricky

"My friends expect curry puffs"

Triggers: Study sessions, group deadlines

Pain points: No bulk discounts, no napkins

Decision drivers: Total cost ≤\$12/group

Persona 3: Novelty Seeker Shirley

"BreadTalk's matcha croissants > Old Chang Kee's routine"

Triggers: Competitor IG launches

Pain points: Old Chang Kee's "frozen in time" brand

Decision drivers: Flavors suitable for taking photos and uploading to Instagram

Segmentation & target market

<i>Segment</i>	<i>Traits</i>	<i>Size Potential</i>
<i>Transit Grabbers</i>	<i>Alex-like; spontaneous</i>	<i>High volume, low loyalty</i>
<i>Campus Allies</i>	<i>Ricky-like; planned group buys</i>	<i>Higher transaction value</i>
<i>Trend Followers</i>	<i>Shirley-like; novelty-driven</i>	<i>Profit via limited editions</i>

Primary Target: Campus staff

Rationale:

Persona → Target link: Ricky's bulk purchases solve Old Chang Kee's low repeat purchase problem

Strategy alignment:

Objective: "Anchor OCK as Singapore students' #1 study snack"

Tactics:

"Group Bundle": 6 puffs + dipping sauces + napkins (\$10)

Campus shuttle-bus ads + SIM exam-week promos

Positioning Statement:

To students and working adults seeking convenient and healthy local food, Old Chang Kee is the trusted Singaporean brand that delivers freshly made bites in lighter and more balanced formats for on the go snack consumption

STP Justification:

The primary target segment is students and working adults seeking convenient yet healthy snack options. This segment is chosen as they often lead busy lifestyles with limited time between school, work, social activities and commuting while being health conscious when choosing snacks.

Insights with APAC consumer reports show that convenience is the top priority for snacks, followed by preferences for low-calorie, healthier options. These trends do align with the target segment of students and working adults. However, healthier options at Old Chang Kee are currently limited, and this brand is not always the first choice for students and working adults to seek on the go snacks. Therefore, by expanding Old Chang Kee variety of snacks to include lighter, balanced, and portable options can directly meet behavioural needs of this target segment.

Brand Refresh Actions:

Product (features, variants and packaging):

Old Chang Kee can expand a wider range of everyday snack products to have more variety. This includes lighter, baked or vegetarian snacks options alongside their classic products. The brand can also introduce portable combo boxes for lunch breaks, study sessions, or commuting, featuring balanced snack options for consumers. Packaging can have QR codes that link to nutrition information, promotions, or any limited-time healthy snacks, combining traditional appeal with digital engagement.

Branding or visual cues:

Old Chang Kee can highlight healthier snacks options in-store and online using signs, labels and social media posts. The brand can also share short Instagram and TikTok videos to show the preparation of healthy balanced snacks, behind-the scenes, and customer enjoyment.

Adjustment to the 4Ps:

Price: *Maintain value-for-money pricing and introduce combo deals with healthy options.*

Place: *Improve visibility of healthier snack combos in stores, kiosks, and delivery platforms like Foodpanda etc.*

Promotion: *Use QR codes, social media content, and health-focused messages to engage consumers and highlight nutritious choices.*

Logical Linkage:

Analysis of Old Chang Kee showed currently there is a lack of healthy snacks options, limited-time offerings and digital promotion of balanced products. Consumer behaviour insights suggest that students and working adults do seek quick, convenient and healthier snacks. However, Old Chang Kee is not a top brand for them. Recommendations would be to focus on expanding healthier options, improving packaging with QR codes, enhancing visibility in-store and online, and strengthening digital engagement with social media and delivery platforms.

Reference:

<https://marketech-apac.com/apac-snacking-market-reaches-us64b-in-2024-driven-by-health-conscious-adventurous-consumers-report>

Technology-Driven and Digital Marketing

Old Chang Kee (OCK) can use simple and relevant digital technology to support a brand refresh while staying true to its heritage as a trusted local snack brand. The focus is not on complex technology, but on practical tools that improve customer engagement and modernise the brand image.

QR usage :

*One effective idea is the use of **QR codes on packaging and in stores**. Customers can scan the QR code to access a refreshed microsite featuring the story behind OCK's iconic snacks, limited-time flavours, and promotions. This supports the brand refresh by combining tradition with digital convenience, while being highly feasible and low cost to implement.*

Simple AI-enabled enhancement :

*OCK can also introduce a **simple AI-enabled enhancement** through its website or mobile ordering platform. For example, an AI-powered recommendation feature can suggest snacks based on time of day or popular choices (e.g. Most popular after-school snack or Top picks for sharing). This enhances the customer experience without requiring advanced or expensive AI systems.*

Digital engagement concept (IG / TikTok) :

*For **digital engagement**, OCK can strengthen its presence on **Instagram and TikTok** by creating short, casual videos showing snack preparation, behind-the-scenes kitchen moments, and customer reactions to new flavours. These platforms are highly relevant for younger audiences and help refresh the brand as modern and relatable while maintaining its Singaporean identity.*

SEO or online visibility improvement :

*Lastly, OCK can improve **SEO and online visibility** by optimising Google search results and Google Maps listings. This includes updated store photos, consistent keywords such as "Singapore curry puff" and encouraging customer reviews. This ensures OCK remains visible and competitive in online searches.*

Overall, these technologies are relevant, feasible, and clearly support Old Chang Kee's brand refresh by blending tradition with modern digital engagement.

Reference (1):

1. Old Chang Kee Official Website

Summary

In this group project, I and my team members conducted a survey around the exhibition of Old Chang Kee. This exhibition has four parts. First part is Key Marketing Concepts and Principles in this part my group member conducted a survey around the 4Ps, Environmental Factors, Strategic Insight. Second is Consumer Insights and Segmentation in this part my group member conducted a survey around Summary of customer interviews, Simple consumer journey, Behaviour-based persona(s), Segmentation & target market. Third is Marketing Strategy: Brand Refresh in this part my group member conducted a survey around Positioning Statement, Brand Refresh Actions, Adjustment to the 4Ps and Logical Linkage. Fourth is Technology-Driven and Digital Marketing in this part my group member conducted a survey around QR usage, Simple AI-enabled enhancement, Digital engagement concept (IG / TikTok), SEO or online visibility improvement.